

THRIVE

Initial Inquiry Response Examples

First Sample Inquiry (Elopement)

Your Name (& Pronouns):

Kristy (she/her/hers)

Your Partner's Name (& Pronouns):

Gail (she/her/hers)

Email:

kristyandgailbigday@gmail.com

Phone Number:

202-456-1111

Where are you currently living? (City/State/Country)

Lancaster, PA

Where are you thinking of eloping?

Colorado. Specifically somewhere around Silverton, Ouray or Telluride. We met while living in Durango and our first date was a train ride to Silverton. We had many adventures 4-wheeling around Silverton. We're open to ideas flexible with timing and just want to create some good old Colorado magic for our special day. One important consideration is that we would want something fairly accessible by high-clearance vehicle. In other words we don't plan to hike miles into a perfect spot. Hope my rambling makes sense and perhaps sparks some ideas for you too. Thank you!

When do you want to elope?

2024 either wildflower or fall colors. We'd consider 2023 depending on availability.

How many guests do you plan to have at your elopement?

Currently thinking just the 2 of us but we might expand to include a friend as an officiant.

How did you first hear about me?

Google

Why are you considering eloping?

Frankly we're a bit torn on this. We first envisioned throwing a huge party with family and friends. The further we get down that planning route, the more resistance we feel. As a recovering people-pleaser the big party wedding is starting to feel like it is for everyone else BUT us. We're more and more attracted to the idea of eloping and keeping the day focused on US. We've been together for over 9 years and we want to celebrate in a way that feels true to us and our relationship. We're excited to explore options with you!

First Sample Inquiry Response

Hey Kristy & Gail,

Omg! I absolutely LOVE that your first date was on the Durango-Silverton train—how perfect that you're heading back to Southwest Colorado for your elopement. As a born and raised Coloradoan, you've definitely zeroed in on my absolute favorite part of this state (both for personal enjoyment and also top photograph elopements in!) The San Juans truly have so many incredible locations to offer—high alpine lakes, rolling tundra, epic mountain passes and 14,000 foot peaks—and after modifying my 4x4 Tacoma truck a few years ago, I've had a blast exploring them for the most scenic and secluded elopement spots—no hiking required!

My 2024 season is 80% booked already but I'm thrilled that I still have some space in September. With you two thinking about fall, I'd absolutely love to share some of my "hidden gem" and "off the beaten path" spots with you two—passes with the best aspen color that also go above treeline so you can get those sweeping views as well. One great thing about knowing the area so well is that if there happens to be an early snowfall at higher elevations and the mountain pass gets unexpectedly closed, I always have some lower-elevation hidden gems that we can still access (and get views of the freshly snow-capped peaks). I can't wait to chat more about my ideas with you two!

As someone who eloped myself, I have experienced first-hand how incredibly right it feels to have a completely "just us" wedding day. I know that the planning process can feel overwhelming at times. Fortunately, you'll find that my role is so much more than just your photographer and I will help you (as I have 300 other couples over the last 13 years) by:

- Being your go-to guide for all elopement logistics
- Finding secluded & unique locations to explore
- Connecting you with amazing vendors
- Building a relaxed timeline tailored to your day

If this sounds like what you're looking for, our next step is a [complimentary, no-pressure consultation call](#).

As you can imagine, every elopement I design and document for a couple is completely unique so by hopping on a call I can understand exactly what you two need and desire out of your day, give you clarity on my process, and answer all your questions and help you get started planning. Plus, we get to know each other a bit better!

Is there a good time for us to chat soon? We can talk on the phone or via zoom—whichever you prefer.

I have **today from 4-5pm EST** and **10-2pm EST tomorrow** available. What works best for you both?

If it's more convenient, you can also schedule your preferred time for a call with me [>here<](#)

If texting is easier for you, I'll be sending one through in a little bit with the link there as well!

My elopement packages & pricing

As a reminder (so there aren't any surprises) if you haven't seen it already, my Colorado elopement photography packages start at \$6,000 all of them include elopement planning assistance (location suggestions, vendor recommendations, permit help, timeline design), as well as travel fees anywhere in Colorado, full-resolution image files with printing rights, digital gallery to view, download, & print + a complimentary album design. You can check out more details [here](#), and when we chat, we will collaborate to figure out what option will be the best fit for you (or if you'd like something custom).

Sample full elopement galleries:

I also wanted to share some recent full-day elopement galleries I've photographed that I think you two might enjoy checking out to get a sense of what telling the whole story of an elopement looks like:

- [June Rocky Mountain National Park Elopement](#)
- [August Colorado San Juan Mountains Intimate Wedding](#)
- [September Colorado Elopement](#)
- [October Telluride, Colorado Elopement](#)

If you have any other questions before we hop on our call, just reply to this email and I'll get right back to you.

I'm really excited to chat more with you both!

xx Maddie Mae (she/her/hers)

Elopement Photographer & Experience Designer // Owner & founder of Adventure Instead

website: <https://adventureinstead.com/>

instagram: [@adventureinstead](#)

phone: +1 202-456-1111

As Seen On: Rangefinder Magazine, Brides, Junebug Weddings, Green Wedding Shoes

["The Woman Who Helped Spark The Adventure Elopement Trend"](#) - Forbes

Second Sample Inquiry (Wedding)

Real intimate wedding inquiry I received with some details changed to make it more in alignment with a typical bigger wedding inquiry

Your Name (& Pronouns):

Carlos (he/him/his)

Your Partner's Name (& Pronouns):

Sofia (she/her/hers)

Email(s):

carlosmenez@yahoo.com

Phone Number(s):

202-456-1111

Where are you currently living? (City/State/Country)

Puerto Rico

Wedding Venue or Location:

Zephyr Lodge, Northstar California Resort

Wedding Date (If you have one!):

September 21, 2024

How many guests do you plan to have?

75

How did you first hear about me?

Instagram

What's most important to you when it comes to your wedding experience?

Really being able to enjoy the day and spending a lot of quality time with our loved ones with nature as the center.

Just for fun, what do you two love to do together in your free time?

We have 2 dogs that we treat like children and love playing with them on the beach.

Second Sample Inquiry Response

Sample of a value-forward initial inquiry response for a wedding photographer that does not include location scouting in their service (as it's not typically needed for weddings at venues).

Hey Carlos & Sofia,

Fellow dog parents! Hello! I have 2 pups myself and live on a reservoir and they are literally my life as well. I also have to say right away that you have picked a stellar wedding venue. I first photographed at the Zephyr Lodge in 2016 and it absolutely blew my mind with its incredible mountain views and I had a blast riding the chair lift in front of the couple and getting images of them soaring in the air together. While my 2024 season is already 80% booked, I'm thrilled that I'm still available on 9/21/24 and I would love to chat with you two more about what you're looking for out of your wedding experience.

As a born-and-raised Coloradoan, I have a deep love of the mountains and my style of photography is therefore very organic and nature-centric—which is why I've specialized in outdoor mountain weddings, both in Colorado and around the western U.S. My focus is on candid images so you don't feel like you're being posed all day and beyond the camera, you can count on me to:

- Collaborate on your timeline to ensure you two are set up for a relaxing experience and incredible photos
- Be your personal hype-woman who makes you two feel amazing just as you are and fully enjoy every minute of your day
- Get a hand-crafted heirloom album in your hands that's a conversation-piece of your memorable day for years to come

If this sounds like what you're looking for, our next step is a [complimentary, no-pressure consultation call](#).

At the end of the day, I think choosing the right photographer is the most important vendor decision you'll make about your wedding. You will spend the most time over the next several months and on your wedding day with me, so by hopping on a call I can understand exactly what you two need and desire out of your day and your photos, give you clarity on my process, and answer all your questions—plus, we get to know each other a bit better!

Is there a good time for us to chat soon? We can talk on the phone or via zoom—whichever you prefer.

I have **today from 4-5pm PST** and **10-2pm PST tomorrow** available. What works best for you both?

If it's more convenient, you can also schedule your preferred time for a call with me [>here<](#)

If texting is easier for you, I'll be sending one through in a little bit with the link there as well!

My wedding packages & pricing

As a reminder (so there aren't any surprises) if you haven't seen it already, my wedding photography packages start at \$9,800 all of them include timeline planning, as well as travel fees anywhere in the U.S., full-resolution image files with printing rights, digital gallery to view, download, & print + a complimentary

album design. You can check out more details [here](#), and when we chat, we will collaborate to figure out what option will be the best fit for you (or if you'd like something custom).

Sample full wedding galleries

I also wanted to share some recent mountain weddings I've photographed that I think you two might enjoy checking out to get a sense of how my style is reflected in a full gallery:

- [September Lake Tahoe Wedding](#)
- [August Colorado Ski Resort Wedding](#)
- [October Telluride, Colorado Wedding](#)

I'm super excited to get to know you both and can't wait to hear all about your plans! If you have questions before our call, just hit reply and I'll get back to you ASAP.

Cheers to the two of you for embarking on your best chapter yet,

xx Maddie Mae (she/her/hers)

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